

BAD NEWS

The team spots the makeup in the first sentence, and starts judging your sincerity instead of the content.

How to communicate an unpopular decision.

THE QUESTION OF THIS PIECE

Do not try to make bad news look good.

THE CASCADE

The message that loses on both sides.

WHAT YOU SEE

You wrap the bad decision as if it were an opportunity...

THE MECHANISM

...the team stops hearing the content and weighs your sincerity...

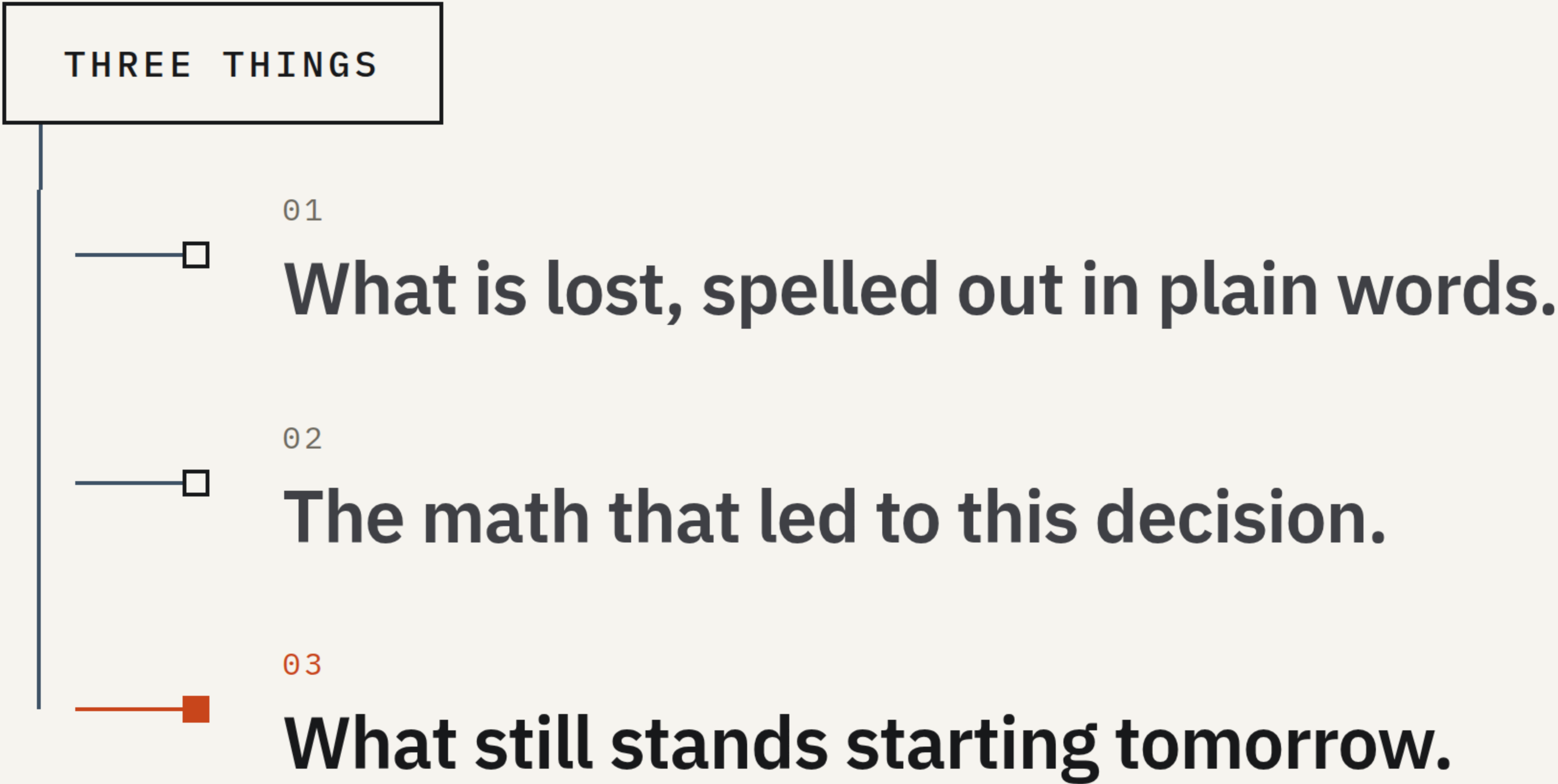
THE CONSEQUENCE

...and the real version travels the hallway, without you.

By dressing up the news, you lose the message and the credibility together.

THE FORK

Three things that have to be said.



Without the first, the other two sound like a justification.

THE METHOD

The no pretending rule, three moves.



01 NAME THE LOSS

before they ask, with no euphemism, everyone already knows

02 SHOW THE MATH

what was weighed, and the cost of deciding nothing at all

03 HOLD THE REACTION

stay in the room, hear the anger, and do not defend yourself

The third move is the shortest and the only one nobody can fake.

IN PRACTICE, IN ORDER

Four lines for the hard moments.

01 • NAME THE
LOSS

This decision is bad for you, and I know it.

acknowledging disarms more than any justification

02 • SHOW THE
MATH

I weighed these alternatives, and chose this one.

shows there was work behind it, not a whim

03 • HOLD THE
REACTION

That I do not know yet, and I will come back Friday.

better than inventing, and it creates a commitment with a date

04

This here does not change.

without that sentence, the team assumes everything is at risk

TWO MODELS

Selling or communicating.

THE COMMON MODEL

Selling

Calls it an opportunity

Sends an email to avoid the room

Vanishes after the announcement

Treats questions as resistance

THE DESIGNED MODEL

Communicating

Names the loss first

Says it face to face, the same day

Stays available all week

Treats questions as a sign they listened

MISTAKE AND CONSEQUENCE

Three avoidable aggravators.

01 Telling them after everyone already knows.

- you lose the right to explain, you only confirm the rumor.
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02 Outsourcing the blame to the board.

- the team concludes you decide nothing, and stops coming to you.
-

03 Announcing and leaving the room fast.

- the conversation that matters happens in the next ten minutes.
-

Whoever vanishes after the announcement hands the interpretation to the hallway.

THE CHAIN

The second conversation test.

01 Two days have passed since the announcement.



02 Did anyone come to you on their own to talk about it?



03 Nobody? Then the news was swallowed, not digested.



WHERE LEADERSHIP STEPS IN

If nobody comes, you go, one by one. The conversation will happen either way.

RUN IT THIS WAY NEXT TIME

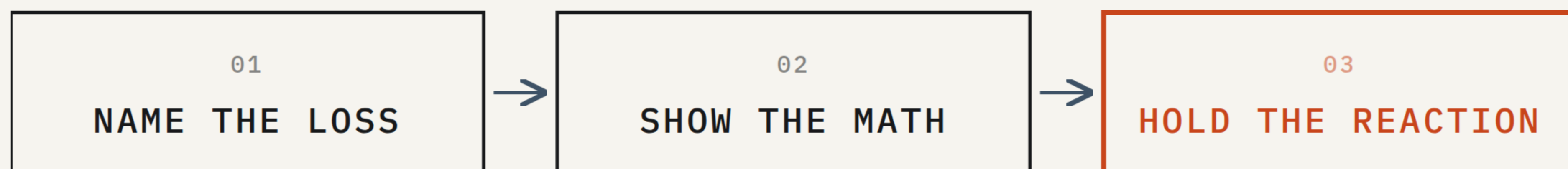
The script for the next hard decision.

▣ STEP 01 Write the sentence about the loss before anything else. if it does not fit in one honest line, you are still dressing it up	▣ STEP 02 Communicate by speaking, the same day, to everyone together. telling a few people first creates two categories of people	■ STEP 03 Reserve the following week for individual conversations. that is where what nobody says in front of the group shows up
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You will not make the decision hurt less. You will make it understood.

THE MODEL THAT STICKS

The No Pretending Rule, in the order that matters.



You cannot make bad news look good. You can make it respected.

SAVE THIS FOR LATER

on the next unpopular decision you have to announce.

FABIO GARCIA

MANAGEMENT AS ENGINEERING
/IN/FALERCIA